

DEQUAD

See loneliness early. Act before it becomes a crisis.

The closed-network student-wellbeing platform for UK universities. Verified .ac.uk peer matching · daily mood telemetry · machine-assisted safeguarding triage.

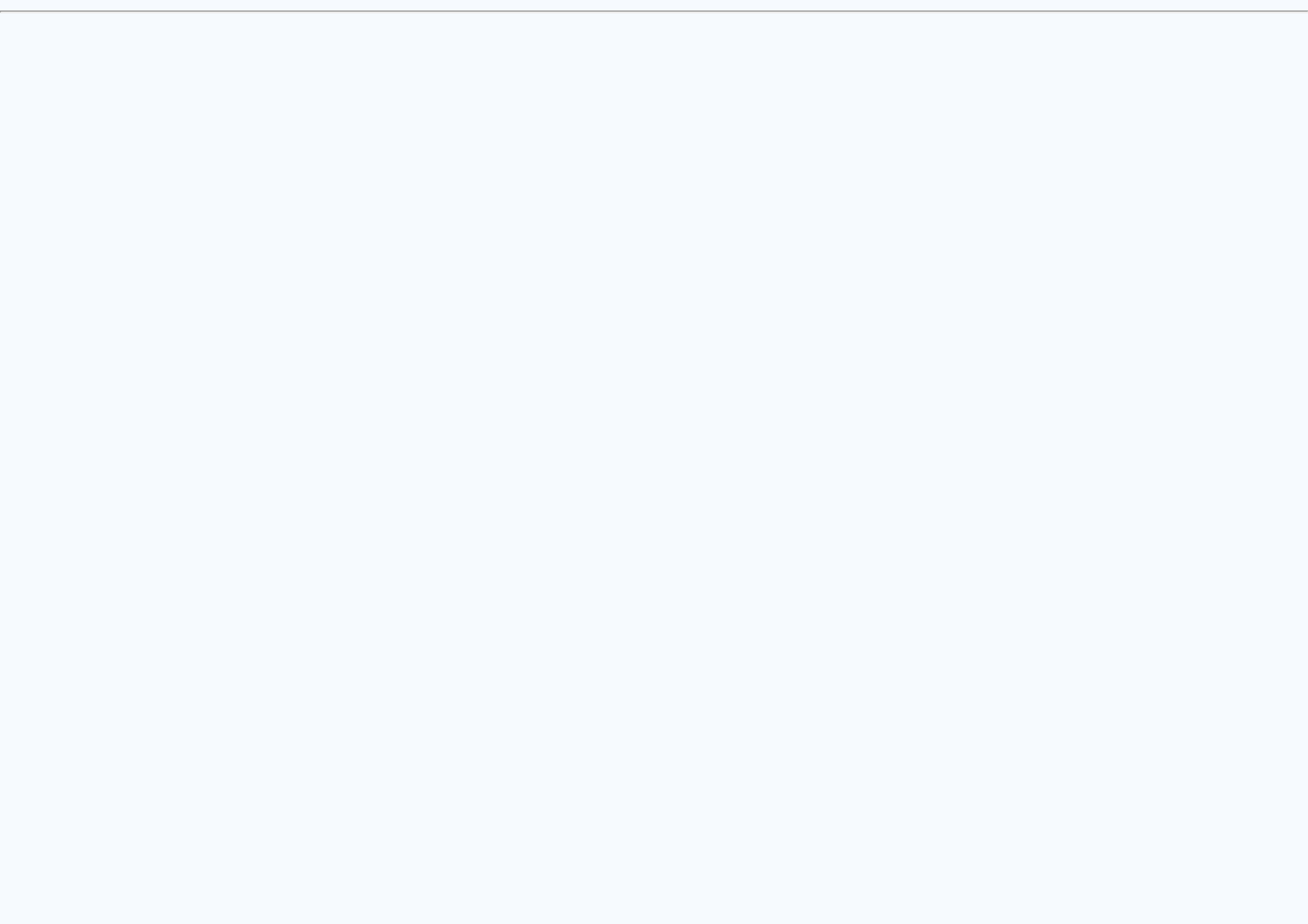
Yusuf Quadri (CEO) · **Yusuff Adeagbo** (CTO) · dequad.co.uk Self-funded 3-year plan · UKES Innovator Founder submission · August 2026

01 • The problem

54% of UK undergraduates report frequent loneliness (*ONS, 2023*) **34%** experience a clinically-significant mental-health issue during their degree (*Student Minds, 2024*) **6.1 weeks** average wait for a university counsellor (*UUK, 2024*)

University wellbeing teams are reactive. By the time a student presents in crisis, the relationships that would have prevented it never formed.

No-one is solving this for the 95% of students who never walk into the counselling office.



02 • Why now

- **Office for Students (2023)** — every UK uni must now evidence proactive prevention.
- **Online Safety Act 2023** — student-facing platforms must implement risk-assessment and reporting flows. DEQUAD ships with these built in.
- **UUK Mental Health Charter** — **100+ UK universities** committed to data-driven wellbeing strategy.
- **Post-pandemic loneliness has not normalised** — undergraduate levels remain **18 percentage points** above 2019 baseline.

The buyer is now mandated to spend, and the regulator is now watching. The window to land institutional contracts is open today.

03 • The product

DEQUAD is **one app, four shipped modules**, live in production at dequad.co.uk.

Module	What it does
Verified peer matching	.ac.uk email + student-attestation; match by intent (friend / study / support).
Daily wellbeing tracker	30-second mood, sleep, stress and connection check-in → personal trend dashboard.
Machine-assisted safeguarding	LLM classifier on mood + chat metadata flags risk signals; webhook to university DSL in < 60s.
University Insights Dashboard	Anonymised, aggregated wellbeing analytics — cohort mood trends, hotspot alerts.

Built with FastAPI + MongoDB + Expo (universal iOS / Android / web).

04 • Differentiation

Feature		Togetherall	TalkCampus	UniBuddy	Bumble BFF	Discord
.ac.uk verification	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Intent-based peer matching	✓	✗	Ltd	✗	Ltd	✗
Daily mood telemetry	✓	✗	Ltd	✗	✗	✗
Machine-assisted safeguarding	✓	Ltd	✗	✗	✗	✗
Safeguarding webhook to uni	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
UK universities served	growing	~60	~30	200+	n/a	n/a
ASP per uni	£2/student/yr (~£20k)	£40k+	£25k	£18k	n/a	n/a

DEQUAD is the only product combining all five top-row capabilities.

05 • Market

Tier	Definition	Size
TAM	All UK universities + ICBs + UK student premium subs	£86m / year
SAM	Russell-Group + post-92 unis > 10k students + their ICBs	£28m / year
SOM (5-yr, long-term reference only)	12% SAM capture (matches Togetherall's Y5 share)	£3.4m ARR by Y5

This is a long-term market-opportunity reference, not a forecast — the committed 3-year plan (slide 09) targets a far smaller, self-funded base of c.£48k revenue by Y3.

- **2.86m** UK higher-ed students (*HESA 2023/24*)
- **285** UK higher-ed institutions
- **100+** UUK Mental Health Charter signatories

International optionality post-Y3: .edu, .edu.au, EU domains → **£180m TAM** in EN-language HE markets.

06 • Business model

Three revenue lines — software-only, **92% gross margin** by Y3.

Customer	What they receive	Price
UK university	Site-licence + safeguarding webhook + success manager	£2 / enrolled student / yr (10k-student uni = £20,000/yr)
NHS Integrated Care Board	Population-level analytics + joint safeguarding pathway	£20,000 / yr
Student (B2C)	Free core. Optional DEQUAD Premium	£4.99 / month

B2B subscriptions cover the fixed cost base. Premium and ICB contracts are the upside.

07 • Traction

- 📅 **Business start date: 15 June 2026** (incorporation).
- 🛠️ **MVP live in production** at dequad.co.uk — no further build-cost in Y1.
- 👥 **80 verified beta users** at the University of Bedfordshire (42 daily-active, 6-week retention).
- 🏛️ **Prospective pilot — University of Bedfordshire.** Early, informal conversation only — **no agreement, LOI or date signed.** A 12-week pilot has been proposed for **Sep–Nov 2026 (M4–M6)** as a target, contingent on the university's decision. Lead founder was Bedfordshire SU President 2021–2023 — direct relationships with student services and safeguarding leads.
- 🏠 **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator** — completed 2025.
- 🏦 **NatWest Accelerator (London)** — joined **16 March 2026.** £31k of in-kind support delivered (office, legal, accountancy, mentoring), Y1 only.

Two UK high-street banks have independently selected the team.

08 • Team

A **founding team of five** — two named co-founders contributing £3,000 each in cash; three senior team members joining on equity-only terms, **no salary funded within this 3-year self-funded plan.**

Person	Role	Background
Yusuf Quadri	CEO · Product & Safeguarding	Bedfordshire SU President 2021–23; 7 safeguarding & clinical-awareness certifications.
Yusuff Adeagbo	CTO · Engineering & IT	MSc IT with Project Management (UWS); HND Computer Science.
Dr Gerald Marfo	CMO	PhD in Digital Marketing.
Adedapo Ajuwon	Senior Software Engineer	Full-stack and infrastructure.
Chinyere Jennifer	Senior Advisor	Senior PM Consultant, MIGSO-PCUBED ; LLM background.

09 • Financials — 3-year forecast, self-funded

(£)	Y1	Y2	Y3
Revenue	600	16,000	48,000
Gross profit / (loss)	(800)	12,900	41,900
Gross margin	n/a	81%	87%
Operating profit / (loss)	(3,630)	6,500	9,200

No external investment is assumed anywhere in this forecast. Y1's small loss (£3.6k) is absorbed entirely by the £6,000 founder capital; Y2 is modestly profitable; Y3 funds the plan's only hire and a small founder salary. Deliberately small, deliberately achievable.

UK jobs: **2 unpaid founders (Y1) → 2 unpaid founders (Y2) → 3 people / c.2.5 FTE (Y3)**, conservative base case, self-funded from revenue. **Job-creation target:** 7 people (5 full-time hires, avg. £25,000/yr, each sustained 12+ months) once revenue scales after pilot conversion — meeting the Innovator Founder settlement job-creation criterion.

10 • Year-1 cash plan — viability evidence

Month	Closing cash
M1 (Jun 2026) — incorporation, £6k founder cash	£5,070
M4–M6 (Sep–Nov 2026) — proposed pilot window, if agreed (not signed)	£4,120 → £3,420
M7 (Dec 2026) — Stripe premium billing goes live	£3,120
M12 (May 2027) — Y1 close	£1,920

Cash is positive every single month of Year 1 — on founder capital and premium subscriptions alone.

No institutional revenue, pre-seed or other external funding is assumed at any point. Whether or not the Bedfordshire pilot conversation converts, the plan does not depend on it to survive Year 1.

11 • The plan • self-funded, no ask

There is no funding ask. DEQUAD's 3-year plan is funded entirely by **£6,000 of founder capital plus revenue** — no pre-seed, seed or other external investment is assumed, committed, or required for it to succeed.

Why this is the plan

Reason	Detail
Costs are scoped to fit £6,000	Y1 total spend ≈£4,700 — hosting, tooling, basic legal/insurance, minimal founder-led marketing. No paid hires, no office lease.
No dependency on the Bedfordshire pilot	Nothing is signed. If it converts, it's Y2+ upside (Section 11). If it doesn't, the plan is unaffected.
Growth is sequenced to revenue, not capital	The plan's only hire (Y3, part-time) and modest founder pay are triggered by revenue actually landing — not by a funding round closing.

If institutional traction significantly exceeds this conservative forecast (5+ paying universities), the founders may explore external investment beyond Year 3 to accelerate growth — a future option, not a plan dependency.

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See loneliness early. Act before it becomes a crisis.

Live at dequad.co.uk · MVP shipped · 5-person founding team · self-funded NatWest Accelerator · Santander Universities · University of Bedfordshire (pilot conversation — nothing signed)

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Thank you.

Deck written and prepared by the founders — Yusuf Quadri (CEO) & Yusuff Adeagbo (CTO).